Learning matters

NHS
Rotherham Doncaster and South Humber
NHS Foundation Trust

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Welcome to our first Learning Matters newsletter

When things go wrong, we can learn from them. Every mistake teaches us something new. This quarterly newsletter is about sharing those lessons, getting better at what we do, and keeping everyone safe.

What learnings to expect from this newsletter
From who? Anyone - clinical/non-clinical patients, colleagues and visitors From where? Anywhere - inpatient services, non inpatient services. Let's learn, change, and make a real difference together! I'm sure you're curious to know what an incident is?

What is an incident?

An incident is when something goes wrong or doesn't happen the way it should. It could be a mistake, an accident, a near miss, or an unexpected problem.

Learning from incidents means finding out what went wrong, why it happened, and how to stop it from happening again.

The aim is to fix the system, not blame the person.

What happens after an incident?

- Ensure everyone is safe
- Report it to your senior
- Complete a RADAR event during the same shift
- Debrief with colleagues
- Gather the facts
- Explore the causes
- Identify any learning or actions for improvement
- Take action

For RADAR training page
For Managers guidance

Support for leaders and managers

The aftermath and impact of an incident can be both traumatic and distressing for staff and patients alike.

Post Incident Response Training (i-Relate) is a safe space to receive support and is delivered quarterly during Learning Half Day's and can be accessed via the staff portal.

RDaSH nurturing the power in our communities

Inclusion matters: what we did

Racism, discrimination, and bullying at work have been reported by colleagues. RDaSH is working with Mokita, an outside organisation, to show our commitment to creating a workplace where everyone feels safe, respected, and able to speak up.

Together, we want to make sure every voice is heard and every concern is taken seriously.

For more information about Freedom to Speak Up (FTSU).
Visit https://bit.ly/4qMZ0PK to raise an anonymous FTSU concern.

First aid kits: What staff need to know

After a recent review it has been agreed that staff do not need to carry their own first aid kits. Please keep following the usual first aid steps and use the kits in the designated areas when needed.

Updates to the Dialog+ (4-Step) care plan

Following engagement and discussions with teams, several enhancements have been made to the Dialog+ (4-Step) Care Plan.

Key changes include:

- Integration with all PROMs (Patient Reported Outcome Measures)
- Clinical input drop-down added
- Domain links
- Flexibility in completion
- Capacity considerations
- Outcome box
- Guides a structured approach
- Comprehensive coverage
- Action planning.

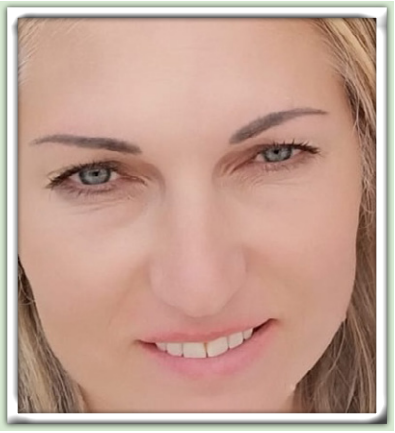
Visit https://intranet.rdash.nhs.uk/dialog/ for more details.

Kindness is being gentle and caring

Peer support sparks hope

Thanks to a Peer Support Hub of Excellence colleague's dedication, commitment, passion and encouragement, a patient who had avoided groups for years attended the People Focused Group peer-led Hearing Voices Group for the first time. They discovered connection, courage, and the possibility of living well alongside their voices.

This is the power of peer support in action!



A patient with sight problems joined a group– no one knew!

What we do now:

- Check patient records before sessions to spot any special needs early
- Add a Reasonable Adjustments Flag in SystmOne to help plan support
- Learn more at NHS Digital.

Why does this matter?

Making adjustments isn't just a rule, it's about giving care that is fair and focused on the person. Every patient should feel safe, supported, and respected.

A trauma-informed care: a strengths-based relationship approach

Trauma-Informed Care is more than a medical idea—it's about how we treat each other and our patients.

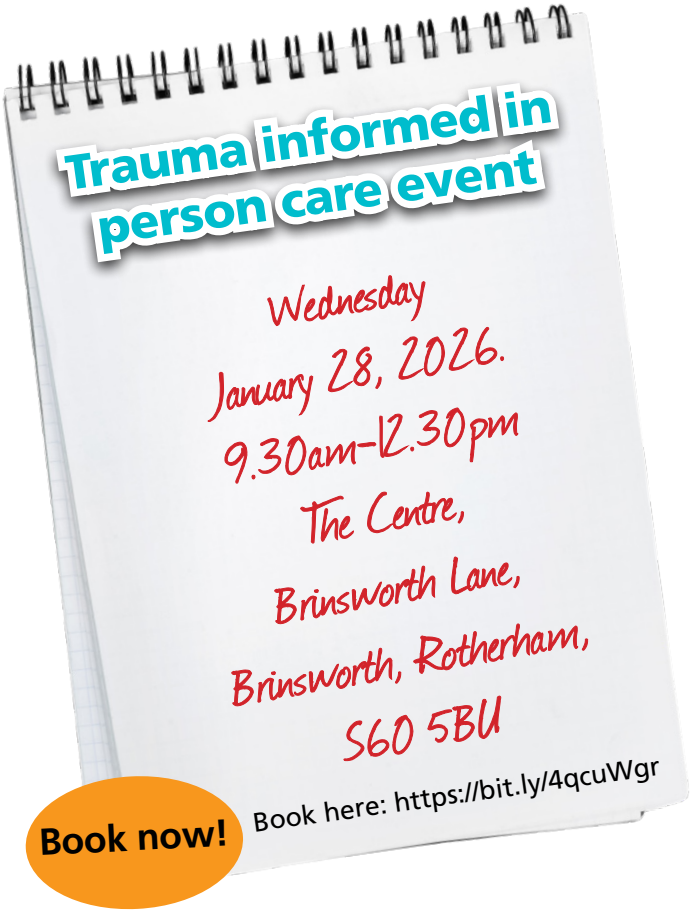
This approach helps us to:

- Understand what trauma is and how it affects people
- Spot the signs of trauma
- Respond with kindness, care, and understanding
- Avoid causing more harm by being respectful and thoughtful.

Trauma-Informed Care means creating safe spaces where everyone feels listened to, understood, and supported.

Let's keep using these ideas every day to make our workplace more caring and inclusive.

Visit Trauma Informed Care Resource Zone on the RDaSH intranet.



Learning today safe tomorrow

Why MAST training matters: skills that safeguard our patients

Mandatory and Statutory Training (MAST) is not just ticking a box—it's important for keeping care safe and high quality.

If we don't do it:

- Patients can be harmed. Without up-to-date knowledge, their safety and wellbeing are at risk.
- We miss key skills. MAST gives us the tools to do our jobs confidently and correctly.

Let's stay committed to learning. Completing MAST means we're ready, informed, and able to give the best care—every time.

Protecting patient confidentiality

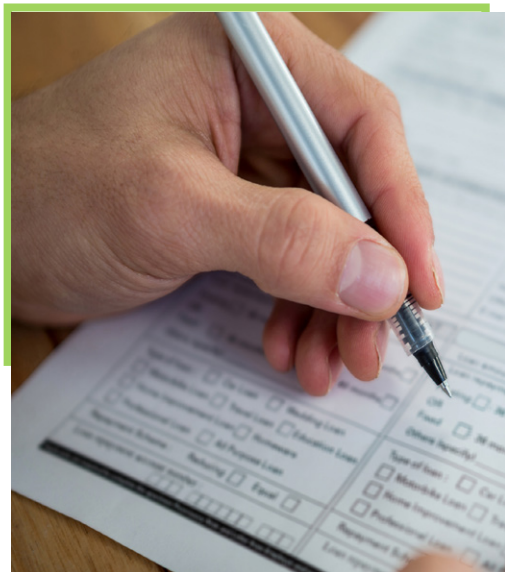
Some letters have been posted to the wrong address.

This is a serious mistake, but it's easy to prevent:

- Check the address carefully before sending any letter.
- Make sure only one letter goes in each envelope.
- Keeping patient information safe is everyone's job

Thank you for helping us stay careful!

Visit Information Governance support for more information.



Right patient, right record: a vital reminder

If you put details in the wrong patient's record, here's what to do:

- Fill in a Radar form to report the mistake.
- Mark the wrong entry as an error in the system. Only keep one patient record open at a time.
- Double-check patient details before adding any information.

Why does this matter?

Correct records keep patients safe and make care better. Let's stay focused and keep records clean and accurate!

For Information Governance policies including the handbook and employee code of practice visit Corporate Policies.

All learning matters

Learning half days: your time to shine!

Learning Half Days are your chance to grow, build new skills, and boost your confidence. These sessions help you give the best care possible. Learning Half Day dates:

- January 28, 2026 9am to1pm
- February 19, 2026 9am to1pm
- March 17, 2026 9am to1pm
- April 7, 2026 1pm to 5pm
- May 6, 2026 1pm to 5pm
- June 11, 2026 1pm to 5pm
- July 29, 2026 1pm to 5pm
- August 18, 2026 9am to1pm
- September 30, 2026 1pm to 5pm
- October 15, 2026 9am to 1pm
- November 12, 2026 9am to 1pm
- December 1, 2026 1pm to 5pm
- January 14, 2027 9am to 1pm
- February 16, 2027 9am to 1pm
- March 31, 2027 1pm to 5 pm

Like a tree learning grows and spreads out in many directions.

The trunk is your main knowledge – the things you already know.

The branches are new ideas and skills that grow from that knowledge.

Each branch can lead to more branches, just like learning one thing can help you learn something else.

This means learning never stops – it keeps growing and connecting in different ways.

Do you have a learning RADAR/good practice + you would like to share? Please get in touch, we'd love to hear from you! Email: therapies@nhs.net.

Message from Jon Rouston

Thank you for taking the time to consider our first Learning Matters - learning happens all the time in our trust across all of our contexts and this is our first attempt at trying to communicate some of that learning across the organisation and share it widely. If you have any feedback about this newsletter please email rdash.therapies@nhs.net If you have something that you think is important to share with others please email rdash.therapies@nhs.net

Thank you for reading!